THE READING SOCIETY

The Commonplace *Book*

Words, ideas & connections

A place to keep what catches your attention,
and discover what belongs together.

THIS COLLECTION

Make it your own

THIS BOOK BELONGS TO

BEGUN IN / AT

There is no required order and no deadline. Collect the things you want to return to, leave room for your own response, and let an index grow with the collection.

Text and page design © 2026 The Books Wanderer.
First edition · English · 160 interior pages.
Cover: Great Cinereous Owl, 1837. Robert Havell after John James Audubon. National Gallery of Art, Washington; Gift of Mrs. Walter B. James, 1945.8.351. Artwork reproduction in the public domain.
thebookswanderer.com

START HERE

A commonplace practice

COLLECT

Save a passage, observation, question or idea. Write enough of the source to find it again: author, title, page, place or date.

NOTICE

Explain what caught your attention. Your response can be as brief as a question, a disagreement, or a reminder to look more closely.

CONNECT

Link an entry to another page, topic or experience. The useful thread may appear weeks after you first wrote the words.

RETURN

Add a topic to the index and revisit the collection when you need a starting point. An entry is allowed to remain unfinished.

A LIVING INDEX

Topics & pages 1

Add subjects in any order. Return to the same topic as new connections appear.

TOPIC / WORD / QUESTION	PAGE REFERENCES

COLLECTION 01 · COLLECT

Words worth keeping

TOPIC / DATE

SOURCE / AUTHOR / TITLE

PAGE, CHAPTER OR PLACE

PASSAGE / OBSERVATION / IDEA

COLLECTION 01 · CONNECT

Room for a response

WHAT CAUGHT MY ATTENTION?

WHAT DOES THIS CONNECT TO?

A QUESTION / PAGE TO RETURN TO

LOOSE LEAVES

Notes & discoveries

An extra thought, a longer passage, or a place to keep following the thread.

ROOM TO EXPLORE

Maps & connections

Sketch a relationship, make a small list, or give an idea room to grow.